Chicken and Broccoli Penne

Main dishes | Stovetop & prep

Before you start

Cut chicken into 3/4-inch pieces, prepare broccoli florets, and freshly grate cheeses. Combine the dry seasonings before cooking. Cook pasta and broccoli together while sauce simmers.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Italian seasoning, mustard powder, and optional pepper flakes

Bowl B - Parmesan and Asiago, freshly grated

- [ ] 2 large boneless, skinless chicken breasts, cut into 3/4-inch pieces
- [ ] Lemon pepper seasoning
- [ ] 4 tablespoons olive oil
- [ ] 1 cup dry white wine see notes
- [ ] 6 tablespoons butter
- [ ] 6 cloves garlic
- [ ] 4 tablespoons flour
- [ ] 1.5 cup chicken broth
- [ ] 2.5 cups half and half
- [ ] 2 teaspoon hot sauce
- [ ] 8 cups broccoli florets
- [ ] 1.5 cup Parmesan, freshly grated [Bowl B]
- [ ] 0.5 cup Asiago can also use all parmesan., freshly grated [Bowl B]

- [ ] 1 lb. Penne
- [ ] 4 teaspoons freshly squeezed lemon juice

Seasonings:

- [ ] 2 teaspoon Italian seasonings [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 teaspoon mustard powder [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 pinch red pepper flakes optional [Bowl A]

1. Prepare and cook

1. Prep Work: Combine the seasoning ingredients and set aside. I recommend that you measure out the remaining ingredients as well, the recipe will be a breeze from there!

2. Cut the chicken into 3/4-inch pieces and season it in Lemon Pepper Seasoning. Heat olive oil in a large skillet over medium-high heat. Add the chicken and cook on each side for 2-3 minutes, until a brown crust has developed. Remove and set aside.

3. Bring a large pot of salted pasta water to a boil while you begin to prepare the sauce as outlined below.

4. Add the white wine to the same pot that you used to cook the chicken and set the heat to medium. Use a silicone spatula to “clean” the bottom of the pot. Let it reduce by half, about 4 minutes.

5. Add the butter and garlic and cook for 1 minute. Stir in the flour and cook for 1-2 minutes, stirring continuously.

6. Add chicken broth in small splashes, stirring continuously. Add the half and half in the same manner, then add the hot sauce and seasonings. Bring to a boil, reduce to a simmer and cover it partially.

7. Boil the pasta to al dente according to package instructions. Add the broccoli to the boiling pasta water during the last 4 minutes, then drain.

8. Reduce heat of sauce to low and slowly stir in the grated cheese.

9. Remove from heat and stir in the lemon juice. Add the pasta, broccoli, and the chicken and stir to combine. Taste and season with salt if desired. Serve!

Notes

Grate the cheese from a wedge and avoid using packaged grated cheese. It will melt and taste much better. I use Belgioioso Parmesan and Asiago cheese.

Make sure the base of the sauce isn't too hot when the cheese is added, or the dairy can separate and result in a grainy consistency.

White Wine: Dry white wine like Sauvignon Blanc, Chardonnay, or Pinot Grigio are best in this recipe and pair well with lemon. Chicken Broth may be used if you don't cook with wine.

The hot sauce is a subtle flavor enhancer and doesn't make this spicy. I use Frank's Hot Sauce. The mustard powder is also a flavor enhancer that can't be tasted outright.

Frozen broccoli may be used instead of fresh, it's already blanched so you may want to give it 3 minutes of cooking time instead of 4.

The ingredient list appears scaled up while the saved nutrition/servings text still says four servings; no yield or nutrition has been assumed.

Garlic prep is not specified in the saved recipe.